

Microsoft 365 Leaver Cleanup Tool

Sherborne Qatar — IT Department | version 1.0 | Quick Reference

What this tool does

Offboards people who have left from Microsoft 365 — disables the account, removes them from groups, distribution lists and Teams, hides them from the address book, and removes their licence. For staff it also preserves their email (converts the mailbox to a free shared mailbox) and archives their OneDrive files to a SharePoint site.

How to start

Double-click the **Leaver Cleanup Tool** shortcut (or the .bat). Sign in with your **global admin** account (a Microsoft 365 admin account — not local PC admin). Do NOT run it as administrator; if you do, it relaunches itself as a normal user automatically. A menu then appears.

The menu

Option	What it does
DRY RUN	Previews a bulk cleanup from a list. Changes nothing — produces a colour-coded Excel report of what <i>would</i> happen. Always do this first.
COMMIT	Runs the cleanup for real. Saves an UNDO file first. Asks whether the list is Students or Staff, then shows a headline summary at the end.
Individual account	Look up one person, see their details (including whether they are cloud or on-prem), then Full cleanup / Disable only / Re-enable.
RESTORE (undo)	Puts a previously cleaned-up account back exactly as it was, using the UNDO file from that run.
PURGE stale accounts	Deletes accounts that are disabled + unlicensed + inactive for years. Protects shared mailboxes. Deleted accounts are restorable for 30 days.

Students vs. Staff

Students	Staff
Standard cleanup: disable, remove groups, hide, remove licence. Any account that looks like staff is skipped for safety.	Extra care: mailbox converted to a shared mailbox (email kept forever, free) and OneDrive files archived to SharePoint, then the normal cleanup runs.

IMPORTANT: On-premises (synced) accounts vs. Cloud accounts

Some older accounts are **synced from the local Active Directory** (hybrid); newer ones are created directly in the cloud. The tool detects this and shows “Managed in: On-premises AD” or “Managed in: Cloud” for each person.

For CLOUD accounts	For ON-PREMISES (synced) accounts
Everything works and sticks: disable, groups, hide, licence, mailbox, OneDrive.	The cloud-safe steps still run here: licence removal, mailbox → shared, OneDrive archive . But disable, hide and group changes must be done in your LOCAL Active Directory — doing them only in the cloud is reverted at the next sync. The tool flags these clearly.

Recommended workflow

1. Export a leaver list (CSV or Excel) — it needs email addresses; names and leaving dates make the safety checks stronger.
2. Run a **DRY RUN** and open the Excel report. Green = will process, Pink = review, Yellow = skipped.
3. Check skipped/review rows, then **COMMIT**. Keep the UNDO file it creates. For anyone marked on-premises, also disable/move them in local AD.
4. Once a year, run **PURGE** to delete accounts dead for 2+ years.

Files the tool creates (kept next to it)

• **result_*/COMMITTED_result_*** — report from each run. • **Restore_*.json** — UNDO file. • **Log_YYYYMM.log** — running history. • **PurgeCandidates_*.csv** — list reviewed before any deletion.

If the tool seems to pause, watch the status line and step messages at the top of the window — the directory download and per-account steps take a little time. Never delete the Restore_ files; they are your safety net.